Database Systems

Tables and relationships

Understand

A relational database organizes records into tables. A primary key identifies each record uniquely. A foreign key references a key in another table. An enrollment table connects students to subjects.

Worked example

Student(student_id, name), Subject(subject_id, title), and Enrollment(student_id, subject_id) separate the three kinds of facts. A student can have many enrollment rows without repeating their name in each one.

Try it, then check.

Practice question

Where should a student name be stored in this design?

Answer and reasoning

In the Student table. Enrollment refers to the student through student_id.

Reflect

Explain the steps in your own words. Create a review card and return to page 1 when you need the original explanation.